

IMD

INSIDER TIPS



ABOUT IMD

Founded in 1990, in just 40 years, IMD has earned a place amongst Europe's most elite business schools. With a class of just 90 students, most with around seven years of work experience, you'll find an older, closer cohort here than at many other top business schools.

The school prides itself on its personal touch (the professor to student ratio is 1:2), strong links to the business community and hands-on approach to learning. Switzerland is a world leader in FinTech, as well as home to a number of multinational headquarters of consumer products, finance, luxury and healthcare companies, and IMD MBA students benefit from proximity to this ecosystem. About 30% of the course is delivered in an experiential manner, with consulting projects with companies, simulations, and other 'outside of the classroom' learning opportunities. The school's digital, entrepreneurial and global environment allows students to develop relevant, comprehensive leadership skills - empowering them to make a real difference in an ever-changing world.

The school, which is located in the Swiss city of Lausanne, a city situated on Lake Geneva, boasts lake and mountain views and a plethora of outdoor activities at easy reach. Many students are active in sports like skiing, biking and sailing. The MBA partner integration programme is a unique selling point for MBA participants with partners and families, and underscores the highly personal, community-driven approach of the programme.

STRENGTHS & SPECIALIZATIONS

General Management, Technology, FinTech, Entrepreneurship

KEY STATS

MBA RANKINGS*	2017	2018	2019	2020	2021
BusinessWeek	5	10	1	1	*
Financial Times	21	24	22	25	19
Forbes	1	-	1	-	-
The Economist	29	35	35	-	10
US News	-	-	-	-	-

CLASS OF 2021 ADMISSIONS

MBA Class Size	98
Total Tuition	€85,831
Avg Age	31
% Women	35%

POST-MBA CAREERS (CLASS OF 2019)

Industry	64%
Consulting	27%
Finance	9%

TOP RECRUITERS INCLUDE:

McKinsey, Hilti, Danaher, Deloitte, Upfield, REYL, ZS Associates, Amazon, Novartis, ATKearney

AVERAGE BASE SALARY: €109,197

EMPLOYED IN 3 MONTHS: 83%

**Rankings are relative to other non-U.S. business schools. [Read more](#) about the Fortuna ranking methodology.*

TOP TIPS FOR ACING YOUR IMD APPLICATION



BY KAREN PONTE

A Senior Program Manager at London Business School, Karen brings extensive experience reviewing admission files at a number of top programs, from LBS and INSEAD to Imperial, Oxford, Cambridge, Warwick, and IMD.



The collaborative environment is a key element to the programme and you should demonstrate both what you bring and what you will gain from it.

1

CONSIDER THE PERSONALISED APPROACH

IMD prides itself in having a personalised admissions process and encourages applicants to connect with them from the outset. Remember that the school is keen to build a close-knit community of outstanding individuals who will make a real impact on the world - so be sure to reach out to the admissions team, students, and alumni in order to establish that connection. The website offers you the chance to have your profile evaluated - use that opportunity!

CLEARLY COMMUNICATE YOUR WORK EXPERIENCE

2

IMD students on average have around seven years of work experience, slightly higher than some of the other top-tier schools, and the focus is on mature candidates who create a small class of 90. Be clear on the experience you've had to date and how that will add value to the class. The collaborative environment is a key element to the programme and you should demonstrate both what you bring and what you will gain from it. If your work experience is on the low side, then be clear on the quality of it. Show the skills and attributes you've developed and the progression you've achieved over this time.

3

SHOWCASE YOUR LEADERSHIP POTENTIAL

The programme is designed to nurture your leadership qualities and the school is looking for individuals who have demonstrated the potential for strong leadership in their careers/lives so far. If you've had leadership experience at work (whether formally or informally), then be sure to communicate this clearly. Equally, if you've shown leadership skills in another capacity (extra-curricular activities, charity work, or even in previous academic settings) - then this is all valuable evidence.

SHARE YOUR VISION

4

IMD wants its graduates to go out into the world and really make a difference, so when you're preparing your application, be clear on your goals – explain your motivations, your drive, and your ambition and show how you plan to make an impact. Consider your personal goals (be clear, specific, focused) but then go on to show how those goals ultimately will bring more wider benefit. IMD has links with a large number of companies that take part in recruitment events every year; so do your research, and show you've considered your first steps beyond the programme.

5

DEMONSTRATE YOUR GLOBAL MINDSET

Though a relatively small class, the IMD MBA programme offers a genuinely global environment – with an average class encompassing around 40 nationalities, the vast majority of whom will speak multiple languages. Show the international exposure you've had to date and how this has shaped you. Ideally, you will have worked in a number of countries, but if not, consider the diversity of the people you work with; the places you have travelled to and your passion for a globally focused career. It is vital that you come to the programme with an open mind, a willingness to collaborate, and a genuine interest in the perspectives of others – consider all the elements in your profile that can evidence this and be sure to have your recommenders reference these points, too.

For more insider insights into IMD please visit
the [Fortuna Blog](#).

DEADLINES & DATES

	APPLICATION DEADLINE	INTERVIEW DECISION	FINAL DECISION
1st Deadline	01 Feb 2021	15 Feb 2021	26 March 2021
2nd Deadline	01 May 2021	14 May 2021	25 June 2021
3rd Deadline	01 July 2021	15 July 2021	26 Aug 2021
4th Deadline	01 Sept 2021	15 Sept 2021	26 Oct 2021



**The best time to
apply is when you're
ready.**

Caroline Diarte Edwards,
Co-Founder & Director of Fortuna Admissions

LET'S GET YOU IN.

Fortuna Admissions is a dream team of former MBA Admissions Directors and Officers from the top-tier business schools, including Wharton, INSEAD, Harvard Business School, Stanford GSB, Kellogg, LBS, Chicago Booth, MIT Sloan, Columbia, NYU Stern, IE, Duke Fuqua, UCLA Anderson, Yale SOM, Cornell Johnson, and Berkeley Haas.

As industry experts, we regularly provide commentary and analysis about b-school admissions for major media around the world. To read our full range of advice visit: FortunaAdmissions.com

With our unparalleled collective expertise, we are able to coach you to develop a clear vision of your goals for business school and beyond. We work closely with you throughout the application process and provide expert guidance at every stage to maximize your chances of admission to a top school.

Our free consultations are consistently rated as the best in the industry. To learn more about Fortuna and assess your chances of admission, reserve yours at: FortunaAdmissions.com

